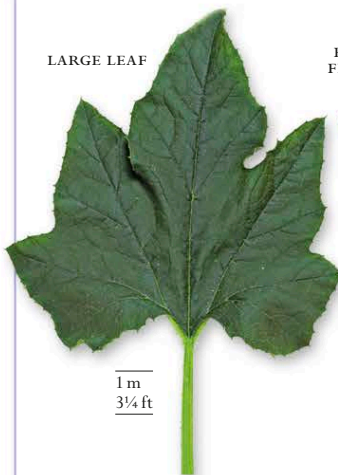
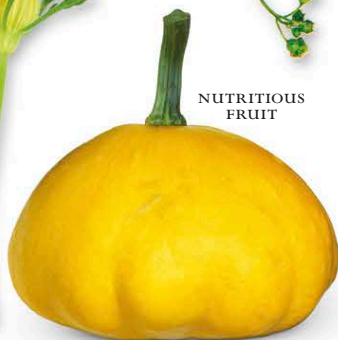


CUCURBITALES

Eight, mainly tropical families of trees, shrubs, herbs, and climbers make up this order. Six have few members, but the Begoniaceae or begonia family has 1,400 species, 130 of which are horticultural plants. The 850 species in the Cucurbitaceae or gourd family include notable food plants such as squash and pumpkins. Both of these families have male and female flowers on the same plant (monoecious).



LARGE LEAF

1 m
3 1/4 ftEDIBLE
FLOWERNUTRITIOUS
FRUIT**SQUASH**

Cucurbita pepo
F: Cucurbitaceae

With five-sided prickly stems and large yellow-orange flowers, pumpkins, marrows, and courgettes are all varieties of *Cucurbita pepo* from C. America.

4 m
13 ft**CUCUMBER**

Cucumis sativus
F: Cucurbitaceae

Originally from tropical Asia, cucumber has been cultivated for 3,000 years and there are many varieties, including the gherkin. The plant has tubular yellow flowers.

2 m
6 1/2 ftHAIRY
LEAVESIMMATURE
FRUIT

FRUIT

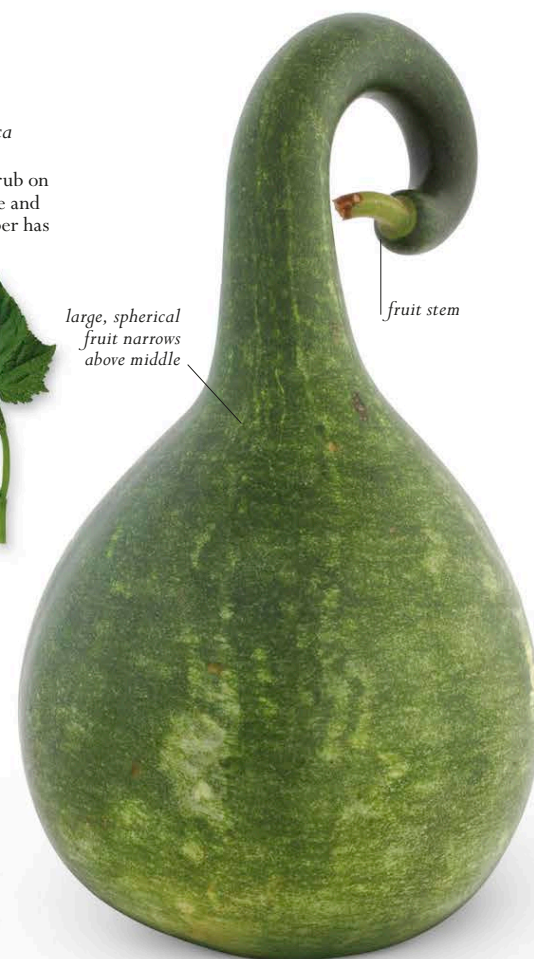
4.5 m/15 ft

LEAF SPRIG

SMOOTH LOOFAH

Luffa cylindrica
F: Cucurbitaceae

This climbing, annual vine, originally from Asia, produces cylindrical fruits. Their fibrous interior can be eaten young, or dried and used as a sponge.

large, spherical
fruit narrows
above middle

fruit stem

CALABASH

Lagenaria siceraria
F: Cucurbitaceae

5 m
16 ft

This vine produces whitish crinkly flowers. Its edible, hard-shelled fruit floats in the sea for months and is used as a container.

**SQUIRTING
CUCUMBER**

Ecballium elaterium
F: Cucurbitaceae

The ripe fruit of this Mediterranean plant becomes so swollen with juices that it explodes when touched, squirting its seeds up to 6 m (20 ft).

1 m
3 1/4 ftpoisonous,
exploding fruitleaf is up to
10 cm (4 in) long

1 m/3 1/4 ft

WATERMELON

Citrullus lanatus
F: Cucurbitaceae

With yellow-green flowers, this annual, prostrate vine originated in southern Africa and its fruits are cultivated throughout warmer climates.



40 cm/16 in

BEGONIA LISTADA

F: Begoniaceae

Native to Paraguay, this sprawling species sprawls, has thick, velvety leaves with a red underside, and white-pinkish flowers. It was first described in 1981.

**BALSAM PEAR**

Momordica charantia
F: Cucurbitaceae

Also called bitter melon, this tropical vine produces bitter-tasting fruits. Their tips split into three to reveal yellow pulp and seeds encased in scarlet coats (arils).

3 m
10 ft45 m
150 ft**TETrameLES NUDIFLORA**

F: Datiscaceae

Props at the trunk base support this tall tree from Asia and N. Australia. Male flowers grow on different trees to the female flowers, which form round seed capsules.

